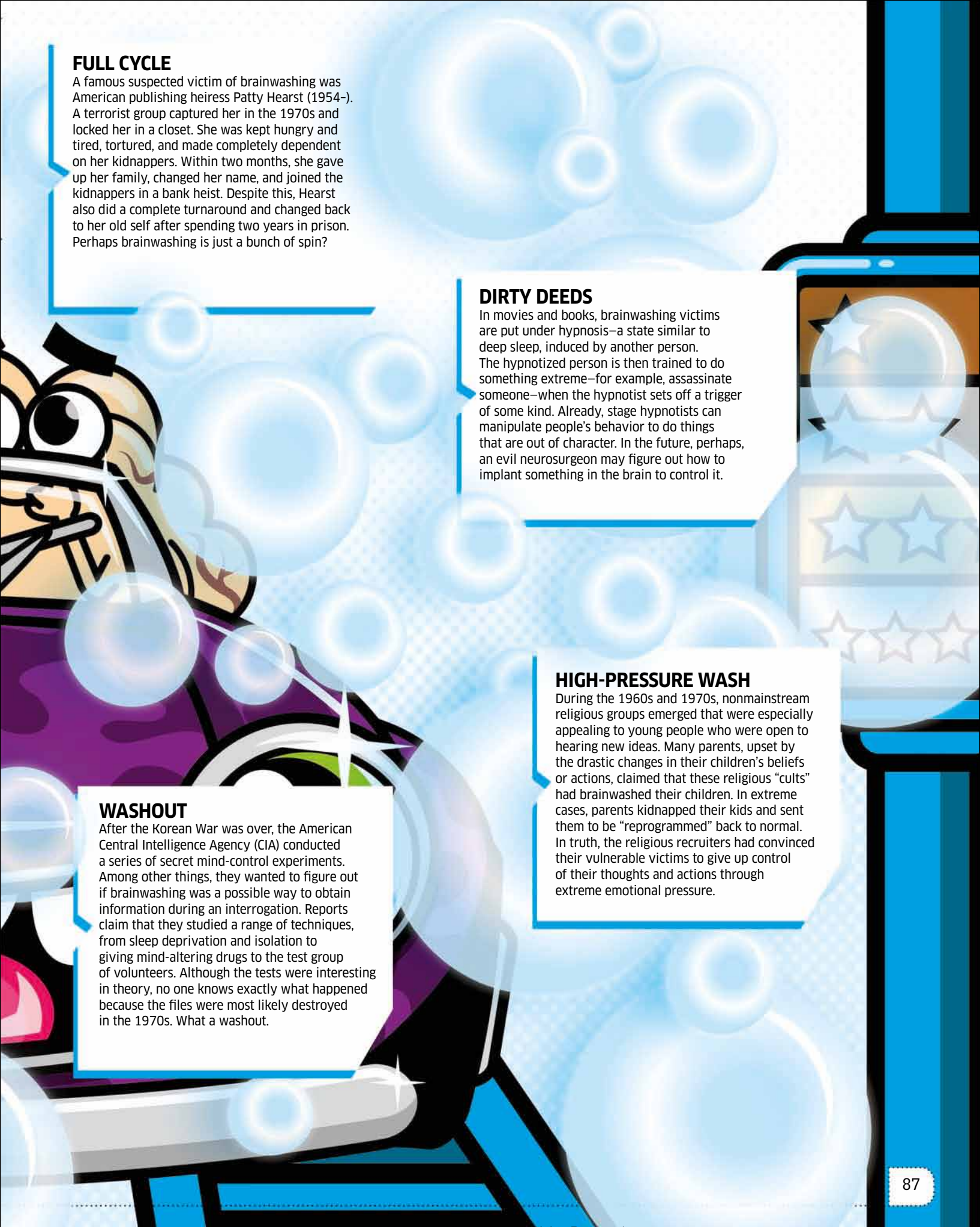




## FULL CYCLE

A famous suspected victim of brainwashing was American publishing heiress Patty Hearst (1954-). A terrorist group captured her in the 1970s and locked her in a closet. She was kept hungry and tired, tortured, and made completely dependent on her kidnappers. Within two months, she gave up her family, changed her name, and joined the kidnappers in a bank heist. Despite this, Hearst also did a complete turnaround and changed back to her old self after spending two years in prison. Perhaps brainwashing is just a bunch of spin?

## DIRTY DEEDS

In movies and books, brainwashing victims are put under hypnosis—a state similar to deep sleep, induced by another person. The hypnotized person is then trained to do something extreme—for example, assassinate someone—when the hypnotist sets off a trigger of some kind. Already, stage hypnotists can manipulate people's behavior to do things that are out of character. In the future, perhaps, an evil neurosurgeon may figure out how to implant something in the brain to control it.

## WASHOUT

After the Korean War was over, the American Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) conducted a series of secret mind-control experiments. Among other things, they wanted to figure out if brainwashing was a possible way to obtain information during an interrogation. Reports claim that they studied a range of techniques, from sleep deprivation and isolation to giving mind-altering drugs to the test group of volunteers. Although the tests were interesting in theory, no one knows exactly what happened because the files were most likely destroyed in the 1970s. What a washout.

## HIGH-PRESSURE WASH

During the 1960s and 1970s, nonmainstream religious groups emerged that were especially appealing to young people who were open to hearing new ideas. Many parents, upset by the drastic changes in their children's beliefs or actions, claimed that these religious "cults" had brainwashed their children. In extreme cases, parents kidnapped their kids and sent them to be "reprogrammed" back to normal. In truth, the religious recruiters had convinced their vulnerable victims to give up control of their thoughts and actions through extreme emotional pressure.